and beyond). Tactical cooperation, as on Afghanistan and Pakistan, is another reason for India to preserve positive relations with Iran. Among the Gulf Arab states, India has recently had more friction in its relations with Qatar and Kuwait. As with Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Bahrain, there is potential to further bolster these relationships, especially in terms of investment. Similarly, Turkey is an important regional power whose relationship with India has sometimes been held back by close Turkey–Pakistan ties. India has certainly made efforts at improving relations with Ankara, including through humanitarian efforts following the 2023 earthquake. Coordination at multilateral bodies, including the G20 and United Nations has also sometimes been fruitful. Widening security partners in the region, including countries with advantageous geographical positions such as Oman and Egypt, is another Indian imperative. Despite the growing relationship with Israel, India has sought to continue its diplomatic ties with the Palestinian Authority, including through humanitarian aid and support for a two-state solution.

The broader region to India's west is undergoing a sweeping transformation. India's approach, traditionally driven by energy security, diaspora relations, and competition with Pakistan, need no longer be limited or defensive. The potential for West Asia to become an important hub for trade, finance, education, technology, defence, business, and connectivity is immense, and indeed is already evident. But capitalizing on these regional transformations will require, among other things, continued efforts to compel Pakistan; engage Afghanistan; transform ties with Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar, and Israel; invest in Oman, Jordan, and Egypt; manage relations with Iran, Turkey, and the Palestinian Authority; and mitigate the fallout from Syria and Yemen. Given the immense turbulence in the region, this will require careful trade-offs and delicate diplomacy for years to come.